What The Fire Saw

-Bianca Ngobeni 30/10/2025

EXT - THE BEACH - DAY

The sun is about to set, the sound of the waves welcomes a group of teenagers, carrying a coolerboxes, and bags, surfing boards, while some run towards the beach, the group scatters into smaller groups, some are setting up the sitting space mostly girls while some are waxing their surfboards and catching the waves. In focus, a young girl, 18-20, wanders away from the group to check her phone, seems a bit sad but then she joins the group again all jolly. Cuts to the girl walking towards the group and then watching the boys surf, cuts to the boys surfing, and them coming back to the shotre as they run, the crew changes as it gets colder, girls wear their sweaters and the guys put on proper clothes too, the groups gathers and then they make the fire.

EXT – AROUND THE FIRE - NIGHT.

There shatter around the fire and one person, a guy stands up and tells a story, everyone is looking at him and laughing, except for two, they look at each other across the fire, exchanging small shy smiles, and quickly looking into the fire. The boy's expression changes as he stares deeply into the fire as the sound around him fades and we are only hearing the sizzling sound of the fire and waves.

EXT – THE BEACH - MORNING.

The fire is dying out and the girl wakes up confused, the group is running home, and her friend wakes her up and she runs with them, she's behind, and the visual of the dying fire is in focus as we see a blurry vision of her running.

INT – THE LIVING ROOM - DAY

Two families are gathered in the living room, the whistling sound of the kettle in the stove fills the room, it's warmly lit, but cold, the girl is on the floor, her family behind, her mother and father in the sofa, the boy is in a chair,his family next to him. The sound of the whistling kettle gets

louder and the girl, Ntando is instructed to take it off the stove and to pour the tea for the guests, he puts a cup in front of young, and they both exchange contact across the hazy smoke in front of them, the parents begin speaking,

YANGA'S MOTHER

The damage has already been done we need to find a way forward and figure out a solution to this problem we are facing.

NTANDO'S FATHER

Yes, but how do we fix a problem without even having confirmation that our son is responsible for the damage that has been done.

YANGA'S MOTHER

Haibo taka Ntando, what confirmation do you need, these kids were together on that night, that the confirmation we need.

NTANDO'S MOTHER

Them being together does not prove anything, these kids barely know each other, let alone remember what happened on that night.

The sound of the boiling porridge gets louder as the tones get louder, Ntando and Yanga are barely looking at each, the pot boils even more and the steam in Yanga's tea, dies out and they both stare it each other with regret.

Fades to black: What the Fire Saw.